## VI execution

While writing shell scripts in vi, have you ever considered the time wasted by going in and out of vi to test your commands by executing them on the command line?

To increase your productivity, it would be a lot quicker if you could execute these commands from within the editor and view their output before writing them to your script.

This is possible and quite straightforward to do. Enter the following command within vi:

```
:!testscript
```

(i.e., the colon and exclamation mark followed by the command that you want to run.)

Then enter your command as you would at the $ or # prompt. The command executes, the result is displayed, and you are prompted to press *Return* to continue. Press *Enter* and start using vi as you were doing earlier.

***—Phaniram Vallury, ramvvs@gmail.com***

## Copy files securely!

Sometimes you may be using *ftp* or any other GUI-based tool, which may or may not be the most secure option. So try the *scp* command, which copies files securely. *scp*, or the secure copy command, makes use of SSH and a session key for authentication when transferring files from a remote system to your local system. It can copy files from remote systems to local systems, multiple files from remote systems to local systems, files between two remote systems, files from local systems to remote systems, etc.

The example below will make this clearer.

Copy file *amit.txt* from *xyz.edu* server to your local dir */mydir* by user Ram.

```
$scp ram@xyz.edu:amit.txt /mydir
$scp amit.txt ram@xyz.edu:/my/remote/dir
```

It can also be used to copy the directory name test as shown below:

```
$scp -r test ram@xyz.edu:/my/remote/dir/
```

When you run the above command, you will be prompted for your password. Provide it and the file gets copied to your */mydir.*

Browse manual pages for more syntax and copy files without a worry.

***—Amit N Bhakay,***
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## Get to know the size of the RAM

Here is a simple one-line command that will display the available RAM in MB.

```
$cat /proc/meminfo | awk 'match($1,"MemTotal") == 1 {print
$2/1024}'
```

***—Kousik Maiti,***
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## Merging video files

Often, we have multiple small clips of video that we need to join to make one big file. Here is a command that can be used to add multiple files.

Suppose you have video .avi.001, video .avi.002, etc, which need to be joined, run the following command and watch the entire video by playing the output file (video.avi):

```
#cat video.avi.* > video.avi
```

The command may take time to complete depending on the size of the video files.

***—Prasanth R Kosigi Shroff,***
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## Auto-insert text as a header in VIM

If you want to have headers or some text like *'#!/bin/bash'* or *'#include'* embedded when you open a file for C programming or bash, append the following lines in the *.vimrc* file:

```
autocmd BufNewFile *.py 0read ~/.vim/skeletons/skel_py
autocmd BufNewFile *.c 0read ~/.vim/skeletons/skel_c
```

*skel_py* and *skel_c* will hold all that you want to add when it is a new file with the extension '.py' or '.c'.

You can use this tip to customise further, as per your requirements.

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END

### Share Your Linux Recipes!

The joy of using Linux is in finding ways to get around problems—take them head on, defeat them! We invite you to share your tips and tricks with us for publication in LFY so that they can reach a wider audience. Your tips could be related to administration, programming, troubleshooting or general tweaking. Submit them at *www.linuxforu.com*. The sender of each published tip will get an LFY T-shirt.